How I Built a Portfolio That Hit 3 Lakh Views in 2 days

Hey, if you're here that means you commented or DMed asking how this thing was built. So here's the real story, no fluff, and actually a lot more detail than what fit in the reel.

Quick disclaimer first

I'm not a coder or developer. I had my portfolio sitting as a PDF for a while and just wanted to try vibe coding, wasn't even sure it'd turn out decent. It did, and here we are.

How it actually started

Before touching any AI tool, I sat with the PDF and figured out how many sections I wanted, what story I wanted the portfolio to tell, and what vibe I was going for. Fonts, colors, overall tone, all decided manually first in Canva and Figma. AI mostly replicates what's already in your head, at least that's how it felt to me, it doesn't really invent taste on its own.

The full workflow

- **GPT:** used this mostly for structuring, taking a raw idea and turning it into a rough section by section plan before any visual work started
- **Gemini:** this is where most of the actual building happened, I'd feed it the structure plus visual references from Canva and Figma, and it would build the section out, got it right maybe 60 to 70 percent of the time on the first try
- **Antigravity and Claude:** used after Gemini's first attempt, mainly for fixing bugs and cleaning up small things like spacing, little stuff I had to manually catch and fix along the way
- **Canva and Figma:** this was the first step I took for pretty much every section, at least for me. the thing that made the biggest difference was taking the exact dimensions of the website section I was about to build, then designing that entire section in Canva or Figma to those exact dimensions, typography, shadows, boxes, spacing, even the images, basically a full mockup instead of just a rough moodboard. exported it as SVG or PNG and fed that directly to GPT and Gemini as reference. it just made things easier since AI had something exact to copy instead of guessing from a text description. this is just what worked for me though, not saying it's the only way to do it
- **Coder friend:** brought in for a few things I genuinely got stuck on and couldn't figure out myself

Section by section, the full story

Hero section

No deep reasoning here honestly, mainly didn't want to show my face clearly, so went

with a silhouette style, matched it to the blue theme, used generative AI to create the base image, then added smoke and subtle motion so it felt like an actual video instead of a static image.

One detail most people miss, the ribbon running through it has different quotes/phrases worked into it, purely an easter egg for anyone spending 5-10 minutes actually exploring the portfolio closely.

Bonus idea for anyone building their own hero section, add a hidden timer, if a viewer crosses a minute or two on the page, trigger a small popup saying something like you've already spent more time here than most recruiters do on portfolios, guess you like this, let's collaborate. never built this one myself, but it's a fun interactive idea worth trying.

Diary section

The core idea was control, you control what the viewer's eye lands on next, like a story unfolding rather than a static page. inspired by a diary and notes style post I'd made earlier on Instagram and LinkedIn, wanted to carry that visual language into the portfolio itself.

Stickers and sticky notes were added purely for personality, picked things that were actually me, favorite drinks, things off my own Pinterest board, so it felt personal instead of generic. that's the detail worth using if you try something similar, don't just add random decorative elements, tie them to things that are genuinely you.

Metro station section

Started as a much wider concept, a horizon line with the metro running across it on the metro highway or whatever we call it, caricatures below, Gurgaon style buildings on one end, older Delhi lanes on the other, hauz khas cafe. looked great as a concept but got way too cluttered and heavy once actually built, so it got trimmed down to the simpler version live now, just the metro and billboards.

If you're thinking of trying something similar, I'd just say maybe don't copy the metro idea exactly, that one was specific to me. the bigger idea was picking something the people you're sending it to would probably relate to, recruiters and clients have likely experienced something like a metro ride or metro food at some point, so it tends to land. this is just what I think worked, not a rule or anything.

Projects section

Kept this one intentionally simple compared to the rest, cards that expand on click, wanted the actual work to stand out without extra visual noise competing for attention.

Visuals section

This one connects back to my origin story, graphic design is where I actually started, back in 11th standard. It's not something I focus on primarily anymore, but I wanted to

include it for anyone who's genuinely curious about where this began. Kept it on the visitor's discretion though, nothing forced into anyone's eyeline, if a recruiter wants to hover around and look through it, they can, if not, that's fine too, it's not something I'm pushing on anyone.

Contact section

Kept this one simple, no concept here like the other sections. After the diary, the metro station, and everything else, I wanted the ending to feel calm

One idea that got scrapped

Somewhere along the way I also played with a pin board idea, a board with sticky notes or chits floating on it, each one holding a case study or bit of info. you click on one, a notice board wala pin will hit the board and if it lands right, a pin sticks it there permanently, like a physical notice board coming to life.

Scrapped it because it leaned too notebook and study oriented for the overall vibe, started feeling academic instead of creative. would work really well though if someone's going for a scrapbook or journal style portfolio.

This is one of 5 ideas I scrapped along the way. the other 4 are in the paid doc below, along with a set of honest tips I'm not holding back on either.

The honest flip side

This portfolio isn't mobile friendly. used heavy GSAP animations without knowing much about media queries or web accessibility at the time, learnt that one the hard way. actively working on fixing it. If anyone is planning to make their portfolio from scratch, make sure to get familiar with media queries, web accessibility etc (prefer talking to someone who knows the tech stuff)

If you want the rest

Everything above is the real process, no gatekeeping on how it was built. if this helped even a little, the paid doc goes a fair bit deeper, all 8 to 9 ideas I scrapped along the way with screenshots, designs and a quick brief on each, plus a full list of honest tips for anyone building their own, all for just ₹49.

also genuinely, I'm always up for a conversation or exchanging ideas, I've put basically everything I had in my head into this doc already, and knowing me I'll have 10 more by next week anyway, so there was no reason to hold any of it back. reach out anytime :)

A Few More Scrapped Ideas and Some Honest Tips

This is everything left out of the free version, a few more ideas I scrapped along the way, and some honest tips, not rules, just things I noticed while building mine.

Quick note before this part, a few of these ideas might resemble things that already exist somewhere in the design world, that happens sometimes, similar thoughts show up independently in different people's heads. Everything here came from my own thinking while building this, not copied or referenced from anywhere specific, just wanted to be upfront about that. Some of the ideas may look unplished and uncompleted in screenshots, thats becuase i moved on to new ideas and abandoned the former ones (idk wasted a lot of time in these but useful for u guys)

The rest of the scrapped ideas

(already shared the pin board idea in the free doc, here are the other four)

The vending machine

A vending machine sitting top center of the screen, a small display inside showing rotating fun text, a coin slot next to it. you drag a coin into the slot and a card, basically a case study card, gets dispensed out like an actual vending machine. this can work with any type of portfolio considering that the main catch is the visual design of the whole concept (you can make it comic type, tech style or wtvr you want to). You all may wonder but this inspiration came from doraemon episodes, haha

Scrapped mainly because the animation got too complex to pull off cleanly with AI, kept breaking on mobile or looking janky. also started feeling more tech product than creative direction, which didn't match the direction I wanted. If you can make it work in a better way, then its definitely gonna be something unique, maybe nostalgic as well.

The folder

A closed folder sitting on screen, hover over it and it opens, cards flying out in a blurred motion, each one a project you can click into for more detail.

Scrapped mostly as I thought it will not go with the diary section idea. It is something that is not going to give you a lot of problems with accessibility across screens, so definitely worth a try if you don’t want to go with heavy animations. However, it may not seem to very out of the box idea if you keep it simple.

The radio

You set different frequencies for different cards, dial into a specific frequency and a card pops up on screen along with a voiceover effect like an actual radio.

Scrapped because it needed a genuinely good voiceover to land right, which wasn't something I wanted to do honestly, and even though it wasn't heavy technically, it needed a lot of visual creative execution to feel right. if someone can nail the frequency matching interaction and get a decent voiceover, this one has real potential and relatability as well. Maybe relate it with old times/ nostalgic moments and visuals.

The illustrated room

Mainly for illustrators or people who draw manually. build out an entire room, your illsutrated character sitting at a table, laptop, a coffee or soft drink can, a clock on the wall, your tagline somewhere in the room, plus personal touches like a cat under the table if you're into cats, or books where each book represents a different case study, or frames on the wall each holding a different project.

Scrapped because it demands actual illustration skill and heavy animation work, not something AI handles well on its own. if someone has the drawing chops though, i personally believe this has a ton of creative freedom.

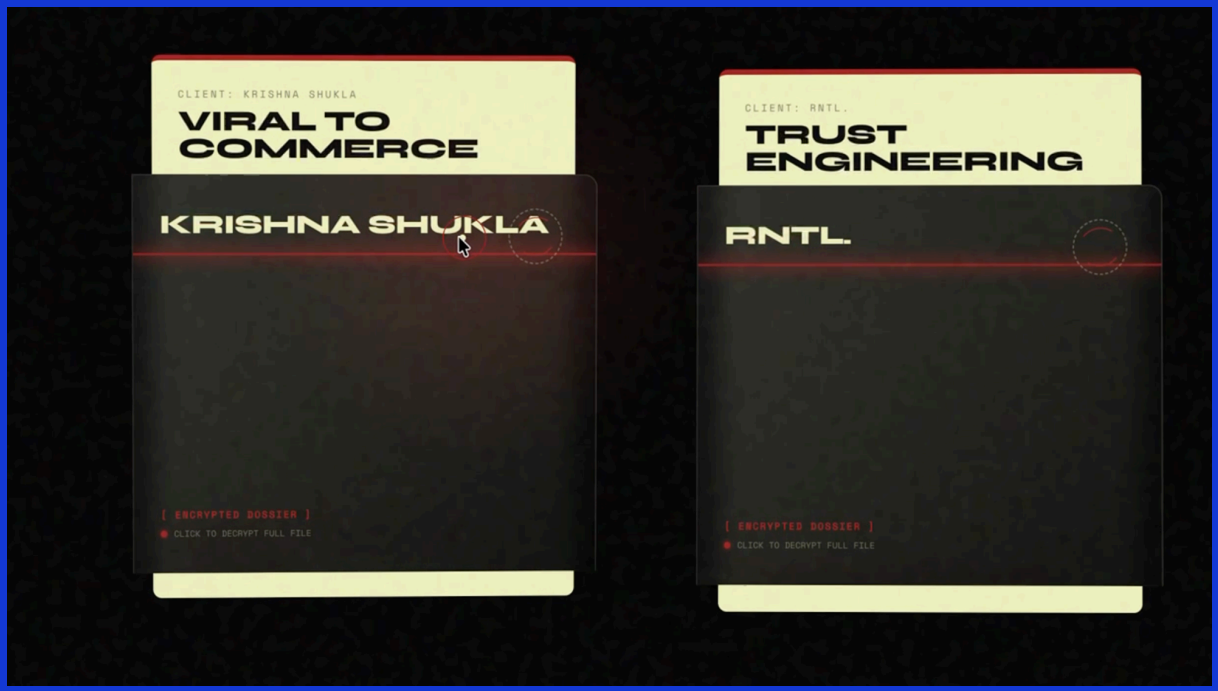
Here are some screenshots as well, will help you for visual references hopefully:)







made this game section where you have to click at the right time when that red line is in the radar of the rectangular zone, if you get it right, the text gets revealed in a coding form. Genuinely don’t remeber why did i scrap this, maybe due to blue theme if i had to guess

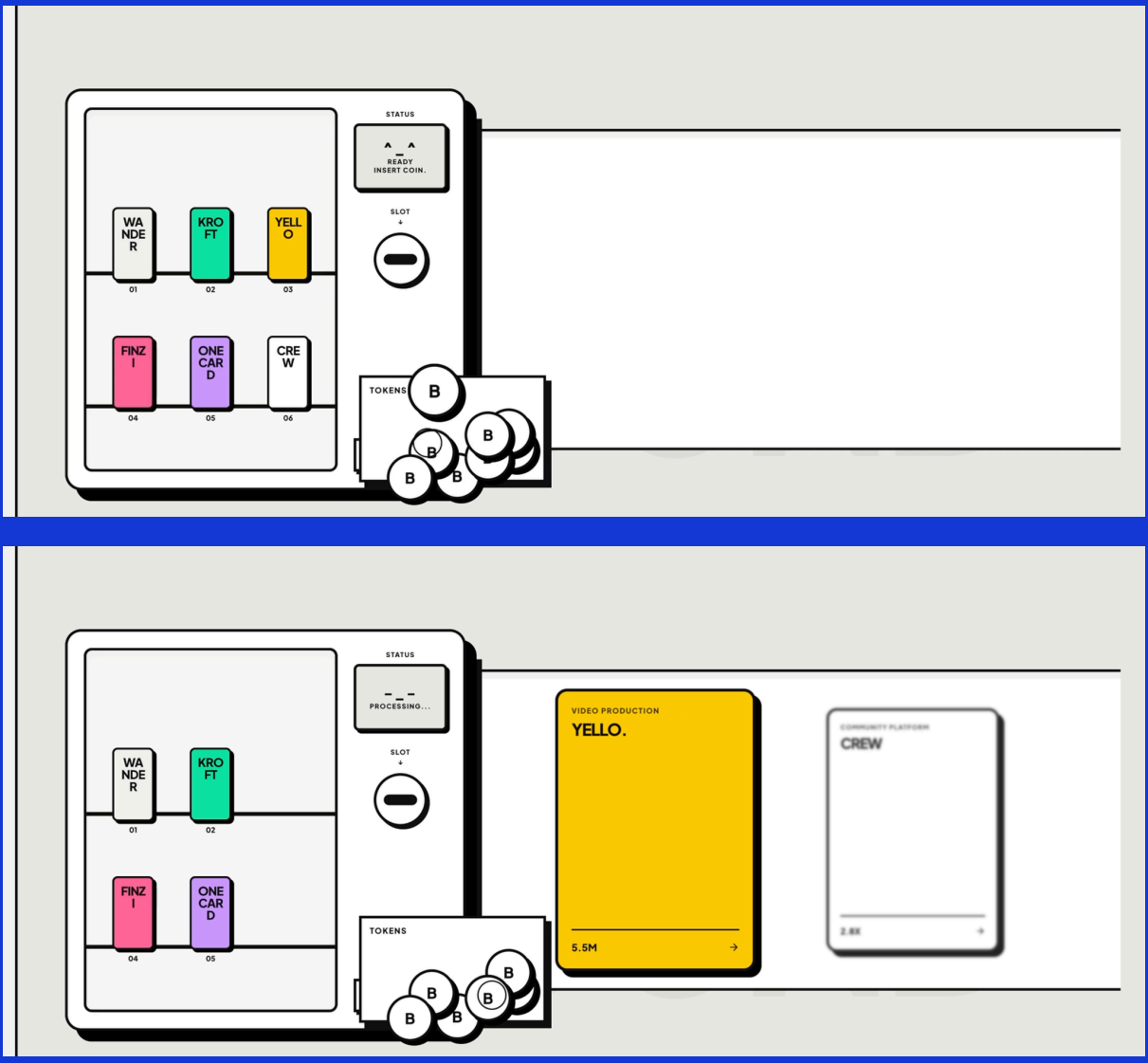




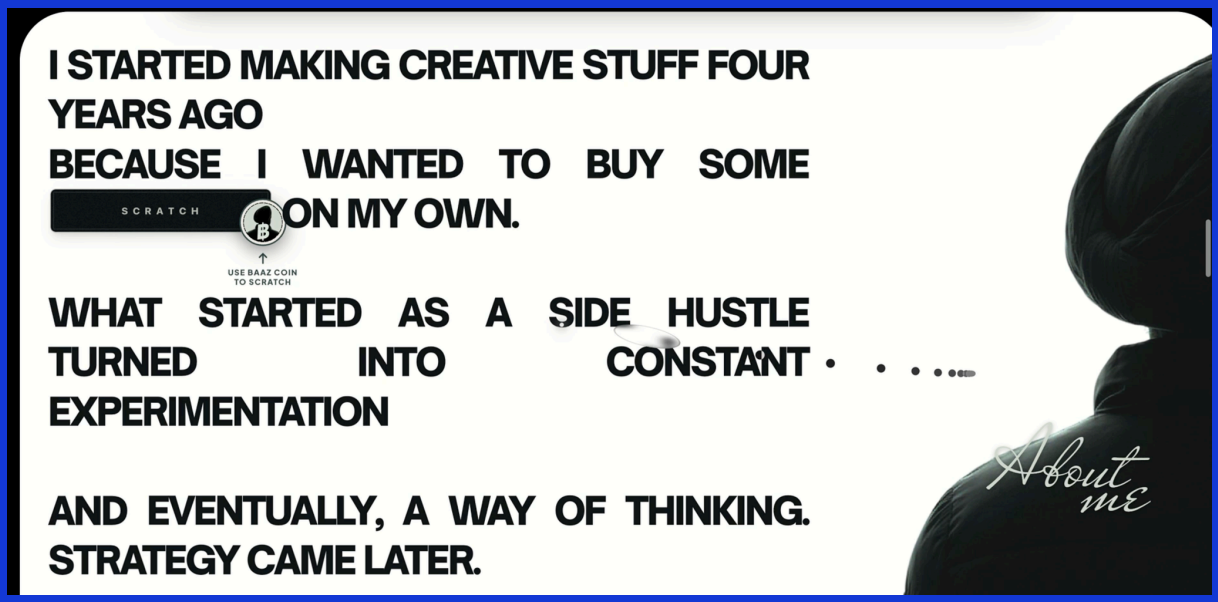
Wallet type card reveal, maybe use if you do something related to moneyyyy, left this midway coz seemed very techy and reddish

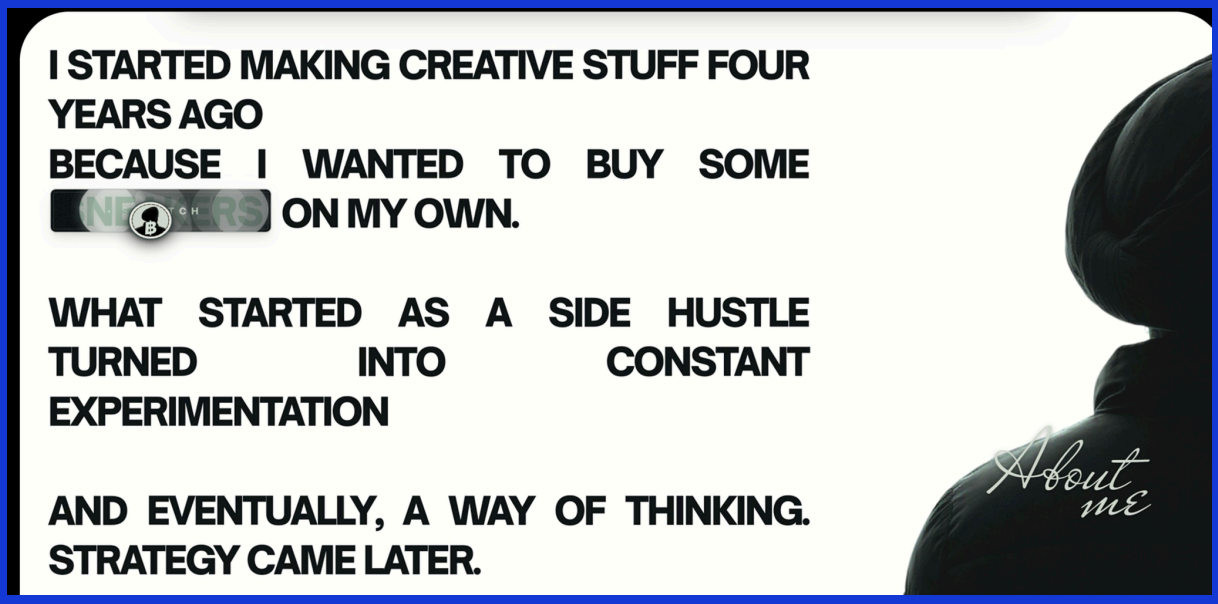


idk, looked a bit too techy so didn't go with this, you may revamp this visually, you may need to go in detail as i had to change the cards position, the way they get dispensed and all that a lottt in this

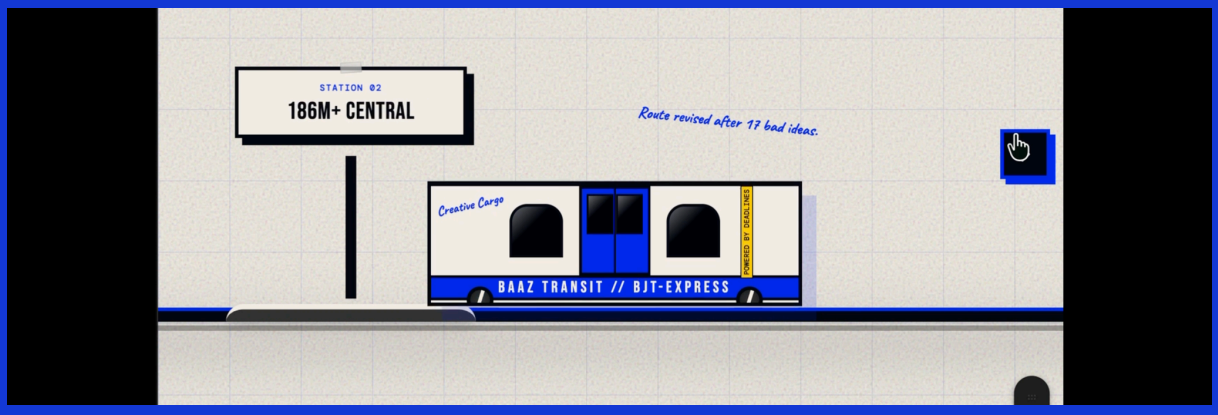


this looked cute to me, good for informal comic type portfolios, scrapped this coz i didn't get the kick at the time when i made this but yea it looks beautiful to me now:)





made this when i had the coin concept in mind (vending machine call back), you can make a coin as your creative element and use it for as a means of input from the user (like to scratch a particular word, phrase etc)



first draft of the metro section🤣🤣

will add more if i recover my screenshots and old codes, will update the doc link

A few honest tips, zero gatekeeping

Putting these out fully instead of holding anything back, mainly because I don't see a real reason to gatekeep any of it. also want to be clear these are just things that worked for me, not hard rules, and I got plenty of this wrong along the way too.

1. From what I've noticed, recruiters have very little time, maybe 15 to 20 seconds before they decide whether to keep looking. that's part of why I put heavier animation in the about section, since that's where the actual information starts.
2. Something I did, and would suggest, is giving people a shortcut if they're short on time. in my projects section I left a note saying these are the projects that built my foundation, but if you want to see the work I'm actually proud of, skip ahead to the best work section. just a way to let people jump to your strongest section instead of scrolling through everything.
3. I tried to keep my origin story simple and honest instead of dressing it up. mine was literally just wanting to afford sneakers, nothing dramatic, and I feel like that honesty is part of what made it relatable.
4. I've got a lot of projects listed too, so this one's a bit ironic coming from me, but I try to point people toward the ones I'm proudest of in case they don't have time to go through everything. just about giving people a choice instead of forcing a full scroll.
5. This one's genuinely a mistake on my end. I didn't know much about media queries or web accessibility until a coder friend pointed it out, and by then I'd already built too much to fix easily. if you're hoping for this to be client ready and not just a personal experiment, it might help to loop in someone who knows development and getting familiar with the some tech stuff
6. One thing I'd keep in mind is not making people click too many times just to get what they want. this was actually the flaw in my vending machine idea, you had to keep clicking just to see each case study. ideally someone should be able to jump to your fifth project without going through a repetitive loop.
7. If there's something you think is valuable but don't want to shove in someone's face, maybe just let it be discoverable, something people find while hovering or exploring on their own, instead of forcing it into their eyeline. (for example, my insomniac work section)
8. In my experience, AI mostly helped with building things out, not really coming up with the ideas themselves. I had to have the actual idea in my head first and make it on canva and figma, AI just helped structure and execute it. so having some sense of design yourself probably matters more than knowing any particular tool.
9. There's a trade off between adding creativity to every little element and keeping the site light, I learned that one by doing a bit too much of the former. I got detail heavy on almost every button just because that's how I like working, and it's also what made the site heavy. maybe find your own balance, this is just where mine ended up.

One last thing

I'll be sharing more from my actual work going forward, detailed case studies, client projects with startups and bigger brands, internships, post production work, artist management stuff, the real stuff behind the scenes. won't be posting often since I genuinely don't have the bandwidth for it, realistically two to three quality posts a week. if you're in the creative field, sticking around is probably worth it, but that's entirely on you.

Closing note

If you're building your own portfolio, have whatever's useful from this, adapt it, put your creativity, make it yours. the goal is just to spread creativity around the place

KEEP MAKING BEAUTIFUL THINGS Y'ALL🤍
ThankYou so much for all the love, am always open to DMs for idea exchanges, creative stuff etc:)